Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Healthy Takeout 101: Key Tips

When you need to grab food on the go, it can be hard to find a healthy choice. Use these tips to guide you towards making nutritious decisions without sacrificing flavor.

Smart Ordering Choices

Bowls over Breads

Whenever possible, opt for a bowl instead of a sandwich or wrap to minimize bread intake.

Rice Choices

Choose brown rice over white — it's more packed with nutrients.

Veggies & Beans

Say yes! They've got fiber and protein to help you feel full.

Chips, Dishes with Cheese

Say no! They tend to be loaded with carbs and unhealthy fats.

"Would You Like a Combo?"

Nope! Don't fall for the "soda and chips" deal. Hydrate with water.

Pro Tips

- **Order a meal that requires a utensil**
  This helps you eat more slowly instead of scarfing it down.
- **Look online and pick your order in advance**
  You'll avoid impulsive counter decisions. Once you have "your order" picked out for a given restaurant, you won't need to look again.

Restaurant Types

- **Regional cuisines** (Italian, Thai, Greek, etc.):
  Eating healthy is tricky but possible. Aim for grilled protein and veggies. Avoid dishes heavy on white rice, pasta, or bread. (Including naan and pita!)
- **Fast Food**
  If it's your only option, lean towards grilled chicken wraps, salads, chili, and oatmeal. Steer clear of fries and burgers.
- **Convenience stores**
  You can cobble together a decent meal. Look for hard-boiled eggs, jerky, unsalted nuts, and fresh fruits and veggies. You could also hit Starbucks and grab their protein box.
- **Top Picks**
  Salad-focused restaurants and those emphasizing proteins are ideal. Consider spots like Chipotle, Chopt, and Sweetgreen.